seed drill, pest-disease management and improved retting and extraction techniques.

12. Horticultural crops include vegetables, fruits, mushroom, ornamental crops, medicinal and aromatic plants, spices and plantation crops such as coconut, cashew, cocoa, and arecanut. Fruit and plantation crops, as components of social forestry, help maintain the ecological balance and the fight against atmospheric pollution. Horticultural crops, particularly fruits, have great export potential and can earn foreign exchange in sizeable quantities, if the existing resources are tapped to a greater extent.

    Considerable progress has been made in horticultural development during the past two decades.

    Horticulture educational system has been strengthened with the creation of horticulture faculties in many state agricultural universities. A separate University of Horticulture and Forestry has been established in Himachal Pradesh.

13. The Horticulture Training Institute (HTI) was opened in Uchani in Kamal district of Haryana in 2001. Set up by the Haryana government the HTI aims at imparting training in modem practices and disseminating the latest technological developments among the farmers. It would tone up the activities of the state's horticulture department and diversity agroactivities to areas like fruits and vegetable cultivation and floriculture.

    Green houses have been set up with two objectives: providing off-season output to the farmers and developing nurseries for future business. The institute has a computerised greenhouse which would help in training officials of the horticulture department in flower cultivation.

14. During the Tenth Plan (2002-2007), the Technology Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture in North-Eastern States was extended to Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. The Small Farmer's Agribusiness Consortium (SFAC) is involved in coordinating the schemes. The schemes also envisage making women self-reliant by providing them equal opportunities and helping them avail the benefits of the existing agricultural systems through the following interventions: